

Research Paper

Criteria Mark Band	Distinction 70-100%	Commendation 60-69%	Pass 50-59%	Fail 40-49%	Low Fail 0-39%
Abstract (5 Marks)	Exceptionally well written Abstract providing an outstanding overview of the work undertaken and clearly outlining the contribution in a concise manner. extremely well related to broader context; scope accurately delimited and justified; aims very clear; outline of treatment of data excellent.	Excellent written abstract outlining the work undertaken to excellent of detail. Outline of contribution very good well related to broader context; scope carefully delimited and/or justified; aims clear; outline of treatment of data very good.	Well written abstract. Provided in sufficient level of detail. This was not concise. Contribution outline was good/ reasonable related to broader context; delimitation/justification present but lacking rigour; aims reasonable; outline of treatment of data good/reasonable	not well related to broader context; area defined but without convincing justification or rigour; aims perhaps unclear or not well stated; outline of treatment of data reasonable but possibly of doubtful appropriateness	Poorly written abstract which does not describe the work undertaken in sufficient detail. No contribution stated or very unclear. Unrelated or badly related to the broader context; area ill-defined; aims unclear, unrealistic, or badly stated; outline of treatment of data muddled/inappropriate/absent
Existing Work (10 Marks)	excellent literature review has made an extensive search and has accurately depicted the field; scholarly attention to detail and showing originality/initiative; ties in very well with defined problem	Good review of literature; evidence of extensive search of literature and has depicted the field with some accuracy but perhaps missed some dimensions; good attention to detail; ties in well with defined problem	Evidence of reading supplementary sources. Reasonable review of literature; has made a very reasonable but perhaps uninspired depiction of field with some missing dimensions; reasonable attention to detail; originality not particularly evident; ties in reasonably with the defined problem	Minimal Evidence of Reading. poor review of literature or poor depiction of the field with noticeable omissions; poor attention to detail; lacks originality or shows few signs of initiative; does not tie in well with the defined problem.	Little or no evidence of reading. literature sources inappropriate/misused or missing; hardly related at all to the field; hardly any attention to detail; lacks originality and work shows very little initiative; does not really tie in with the defined problem
Methodology (10 Marks)	appropriate methods selected and justified; expertly handled; exceptional understanding of implications/limitations. very good understanding of data collected; analysed and used data very well	appropriate methods selected and justified; wide knowledge of techniques; Wide understanding of implications /limitations. good understanding of data collection, preparation, and cleaning; analysed and used data well	appropriate methods selected and justified although some weakness; reasonable handling of techniques; reasonable understanding of implications/limitations. reasonable understanding of data collection, preparation, and cleaning with perhaps some error or minor confusion in analysis and use of the data	Methods only just appropriate; weak justification; poor handling of techniques; poor/hardly any understanding of implications/limitations. little understanding of data collection, preparation and cleaning with errors or confusion in analysis and use of data	Methods inappropriate / misunderstood/misused; poor handling giving rise to serious doubts about validity of process and products; poor/no understanding of implications /limitations. poor understanding of data collection, preparation and cleaning with serious errors/confusion in analysis and use of data perhaps hardly analysed/used at all
Results (10 Marks)	results very clearly presented and related well to the defined problem showing really good integration of this work with the broader field.	results clearly presented and quite well related to the defined problem showing good, but not outstanding, relevance of this work to the broader field	results mostly clear and reasonably well related to the defined problem; results reasonably relevant to the broader field	results often unclear/poorly presented; shows some relationship to the defined problem but perhaps patchy; results only marginally relevant to the broader field	results mostly unclear/badly presented; badly related or unrelated to the defined problem; little/no relevance to the broader field
Discussion and Conclusions (10 Marks)	logically derived and fully supported by foregoing evidence; well-organised; evidence of initiative/originality; good awareness of future avenues for investigation and research proposals for such; awareness of the limitations of the project and methods employed	logically derived but less evidence of initiative/originality; simple awareness of needs for further investigation; some awareness of limitations of project and methods of employed	logically derived but less evidence of initiative/originality; simple awareness of needs for further investigation; some awareness of future needs and/or limitations of project and methods employed	not fully logical, some conclusions/recommendations omitted; insight into value of the work not demonstrated; no awareness of future research needs	based on uncertain evidence; frequently illogical; conclusions and/or recommendations omitted or little evidence of organisation in conclusions; no/mistaken views about what the work shows
References and Presentation (5 Marks)	Outstanding quality and clarity of expression. Paper well formatted in keeping with guidelines. Paper excellently structured. Outstanding use of referencing from highly reputable sources	Excellent formatted in keeping with guidelines. Good structure and clearly expressed ideas and concepts. Comprehensive use of referencing though scope for more/ higher quality articles to be included	Paper generally well formatted/ structure, though room for improvement. References adequate, generally of good quality and used appropriately with room for improvement.	Paper is poorly structured or in keeping with format. Referencing inadequate. Small number of references used, however these are of poor quality or not relevant.	Paper is inadequately structured and not keeping with formatting guidelines. Referencing inadequate. Poor use of references, incomplete, missing or from poor quality sources.